13

MOSCOW NIGHT

The US media reports that arrived in Moscow on Monday, October 22, 1962, left no doubt that there was a major crisis in Washington, with all arrows pointing toward Cuba.

Kennedy managed to keep secret the meetings of his advisers in the course of the week, but over the weekend the media picked up clear signs that something was wrong: high officials kept coming to their offices and staying there until late hours, the lights in their windows sending an alarm far beyond the DC area. Kennedy asked the publishers of the *New York Times* and *Washington Post* not to publish anything on the subject. The newspapers did not publish anything that their reporters acquired from confidential sources in the government, but articles based on open or nonconfidential information continued to appear in the press. The reporters had already figured out that the crisis concerned Cuba, and that a major new policy move was about to be announced, possibly a blockade of the island.[1]